another ‘parallel policy structure’ that further diminished the power of the cabinet and the prime minister.[27]

Narendra Modi does not face Manmohan Singh’s constraints. His election in 2014 was seen as a personal mandate for drastic changes in foreign and domestic policies. Modi’s experience as a state chief minister has made him aware of how the permanent bureaucracy might slow down policy change. As a pro-business conservative from one of India’s states, he distrusts the Delhi-based machinery of state and has sought to concentrate even greater power in his PMO.

Like Nehru, Modi appears passionate about foreign policy and like Rajiv he is sceptical of the existing set-up and seeks to use his own key advisers. Like Indira he has a small group of advisers he trusts and like Vajpayee he has appointed someone dependable as his national security adviser. Modi prefers to deal directly with his officers, instead of through their ministerial superiors, a practice similar to that of Nehru. He has also built a direct relationship with the Indian public, using both traditional media and modern instruments like social media.

THE ROLE OF PARLIAMENT

India’s parliament plays a lesser role in formulation and execution of foreign policy than in other parliamentary democracies. This is not what the founders of modern India envisaged. The record of discussions in the Constituent Assembly soon after Independence shows that India’s founding elite wanted parliament to be supreme in the conduct of international affairs. H.V. Kamath, a member of the Constituent Assembly, argued: ‘I am sure that Parliament will ultimately decide our international relations. It is neither the executive nor the President but Parliament which will have the final word on what out foreign relations are going to be, what our international policy is going to be.’[28] Kamath’s sentiment was shared by other Constituent Assembly members and, as a result, Articles 246 and 253